



KAMINEY Rs 40 crore

STARRING Priyanka Chopra, Shahid Kapur

HYPE There are two Shahids. One lisps. The other stammers. Amole Gupte, prevented from becoming a director by Aamir Khan, turns actor.

HOPE The loooong Priyanka-Shahid kiss will not set off more speculation about are-they-are-they-not going around.

STRIKE IMPACT Promos have to begin again. Release postponed from June to August.



streets this month, may be a little too optimistic in hoping for Rs 120 crore from distributors.

How long a year can be. Just two years ago, the Rs 25-crore *Om Shanti Om* was sold to Eros for Rs 73 crore. Last year, *Ghajini* went to Indian Films for Rs 91 crore, excluding the music rights. Companies, some having raised money in London's AIM (Eros raised \$45 million, Indian Films \$110 million and UTV \$70 million), were eager to buy movies at any price to enhance their project slate, while others, having been listed or wanting to be listed on the Indian stock market, such as Shree Ashtavinayak and Venus, chased too few stars with too much money to boost their valuation. "The corporates were making proposals on a 20-year calculation to create a perception for shareholders. Everyone forgot the fundamentals," says director Subhash Ghai whose Rs 50-crore *Yuvraaj* made only Rs 30 crore at the box office last year.

The fundamentals were, and still are, shifting. The global recession snipped off 65 per cent of the satellite rights. Take a movie like *Chandni Chowk to China*. Though it had an offer of Rs 11 crore a week before its release, the price fell to Rs 5 crore after its crashlanding. Contrast this with *Singh is King*, which was successful at the box office but even more in its satellite rights negotiation, snagging Rs 25 crore on syndication. Music rights, slipsiding away for many years, got to rock bottom—a 25 per cent fall, with even a globally acclaimed score like *Slumdog Millionaire* fetching only Rs 25 lakh from T-Series, which in turn took advantage of the Congress party's political desperation and sold the rights to one song, *Jai ho*, for Rs 1.5 crore. The overseas box office fared no better, dropping by 30 per cent, with filmgoing clearly lower down in the diaspora priority.

Suddenly, domestic theatrical revenue started to look important. Which explains the clash between the multiplexes and the produc-